

Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

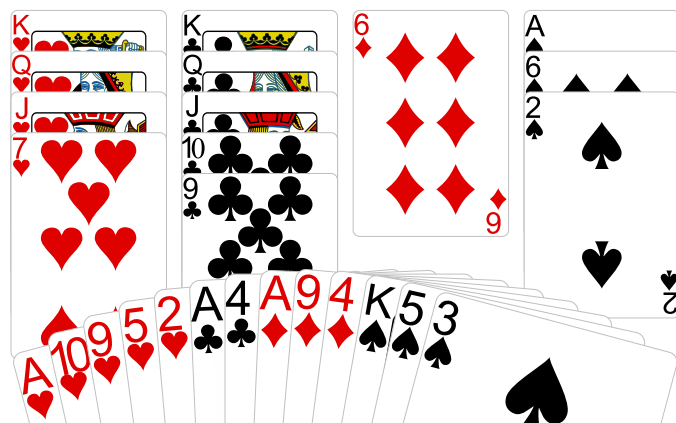
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Deal 1 Ctr: 7♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 5♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



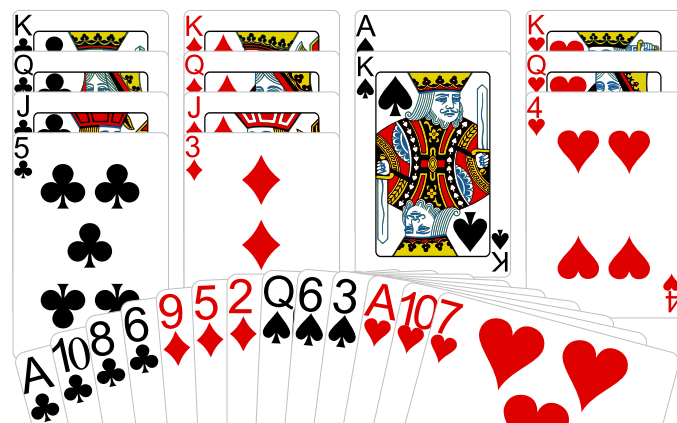
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 7NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 4 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 7♥

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 5♥

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 7NT

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: West

Deal 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 9 8
♥ 6
♦ K T 8 7 3 2
♣ 7 3

15
6 3
16

♠ K 5 3
♥ A T 9 5 2
♦ A 9 4
♣ A 4



♠ A 6 2
♥ K Q J 7
♦ 6
♣ K Q J T 9

♠ T 7 4
♥ 8 4 3
♦ Q J 5
♣ 8 6 5 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♦
Pass	5NT	Pass	7 ♥
All Pass			
7 ♥ by North			

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When SOUTH answers Blackwood with one Ace NORTH decides to bid 5NT to ask for Kings.

With two Kings, SOUTH would bid 6



.

But she knows that if she does so, NORTH might stop right there.

Knowing the 5NT bid guarantees all four Aces, SOUTH figures her ♣ suit will

supply five tricks so she bids 7



Deal 2

East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 8 7
♥ Q 9 7 4
♦ K Q 5
♣ A T 8 3

5
11 20
4

♠ T 6 4 2
♥ T 8
♦ A J T 9 2
♣ 7 6



♠ J 9 3
♥ K 3
♦ 8 7 4 3
♣ 9 5 4 2

♠ A K Q 5
♥ A J 6 5 2
♦ 6
♣ K Q J

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♦	Pass	5♥	
All Pass			
5♥ by East			

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EAST thinks there might be slam if WEST holds both minor Aces, so he tries Blackwood.

When WEST shows just one Ace EAST is afraid he will have a trump loser as well, so

he stops at 5



.

It turns out that EAST might make twelve tricks, depending on the



K situation.

Deal 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ T 9 7 5 3

♥ T

♦ J 8 7

♣ Q J 6 2

16

4 2

18

♠ K 4 2

♥ A Q J 8 7 4 2

♦ K

♣ K 3



♠ A J 6

♥ K 5

♦ A Q 6 2

♣ A 9 7 4

♠ Q 8

♥ 9 6 3

♦ T 9 5 4 3

♣ T 8 5

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NORTH might be tempted to blast into Blackwood with his first bid, pushing toward some slam

in



s. He chooses to temporize with a 1



West

North

East

South

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♦

Pass

4 ♣

Pass

2NT

Pass

5 ♣

Pass

4NT

Pass

7NT

5 ♥

All Pass

7NT by South

response and is rewarded when SOUTH jumps to 2NT (18-19 points).

The Notrump bid prevents NORTH from using Blackwood, but Gerber 4 ♣ will work just fine.

When he discovers that SOUTH holds three Aces and one King he can count thirteen tricks.

Deal 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 6 3
 ♥ A T 7
 ♦ 9 5 2
 ♣ A T 8 6

2
 10 24
 4

♠ J T 7 2
 ♥ J 6 5 3 2
 ♦ 7 6 4
 ♣ 3



♠ 9 8 5 4
 ♥ 9 8
 ♦ A T 8
 ♣ 9 7 4 2

♠ A K
 ♥ K Q 4
 ♦ K Q J 3
 ♣ K Q J 5

West	North	East	South
		2♣	Pass
2NT	Pass	4♣	Pass
4♠	Pass	6NT	
All Pass			
6NT by West			

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WEST responds 2NT, showing 8+ points with no 5-card suit.

EAST only needs to know how many Aces are in the WEST hand. He must use Gerber since

4NT in this situation would not be Blackwood.

When WEST shows two Aces EAST bids 6NT.